Northwind Employee Handbook 2026

Version 4.0, effective 1 January 2026. Owned by People Operations. This handbook applies to every Northwind Robotics employee in Austin, Berlin and Pune. Where local law gives you more, local law wins.

Welcome to Northwind

Northwind Robotics designs, builds and operates autonomous mobile robots for warehouses. We were founded in 2019 and today run more than 1,300 robots for over 200 customers. Our mission is to take the walking out of warehouse work so people can spend their shifts on the jobs that need judgement.

Every new joiner gets an onboarding buddy for the first 60 days and a 30, 60 and 90 day check-in with their manager.

Working hours and flexibility

The standard working week is 40 hours. Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 16:00 in your office's local time zone; outside core hours you choose when to work, as long as your team can rely on you.

Overtime for hourly roles must be approved in advance by your manager and is paid at 1.5 times the normal rate.

Remote work

Northwind is hybrid by default: three days a week in the office and two days wherever you work best. Fully remote arrangements need approval from your department head and People Operations.

You may work from another country for up to 30 days in a calendar year. Each trip needs written approval from your manager and People Operations at least 10 working days before you travel, because tax, visa and data protection rules differ by country. Robot field work and access to customer sites are not allowed from abroad.

Time off

Annual leave. Every full-time employee receives 24 working days of paid annual leave per year, accrued at two days per month. Part-time employees receive a pro-rated amount. Up to 5 unused days may be carried over into the next year and must be used by 31 March.

Public holidays. You get the public holidays of the office you are contracted to. The People Operations calendar lists them every December.

Sick leave. You receive 10 paid sick days per year. Tell your manager as early as you can on the first day. A doctor's note is required after three consecutive sick days.

Parental leave. Primary caregivers receive 26 weeks of fully paid parental leave. Secondary caregivers receive 12 weeks of fully paid leave. Leave can start up to four weeks before the expected birth or adoption date and must be taken within 18 months of it. When you return you can work a phased return of four weeks at 80 percent of your hours on full pay.

Bereavement leave. Up to 5 paid days for the loss of a close family member, and 2 days for extended family.

Requesting leave. Request leave in the HR portal at least two weeks ahead for anything longer than three days. Your manager approves or declines within three working days.

Travel and expenses

Book all travel through TripDesk so we know where you are if something goes wrong. Choose the most economical option that gets the job done.

- Flights: economy class for flights under 6 hours. Business class is allowed for flights of 6 hours or longer, or for overnight flights followed by a working day.
- Hotels: up to $220 per night in the United States, 180 euros per night in Europe and 9,000 rupees per night in India.
- Meals: a daily meal allowance of $75 in the United States, 60 euros in Europe and 3,500 rupees in India.
- Ground transport: public transport or ride sharing; rental cars need manager approval.

Submit expenses in the finance portal within 30 days of the trip with receipts for anything over $25. Expenses submitted later than 90 days are not reimbursed.

Item	United States	Europe	India
Hotel per night	$220	180 euros	9,000 rupees
Meals per day	$75	60 euros	3,500 rupees
Receipt required above	$25	25 euros	2,000 rupees

Equipment and learning

You get a laptop on your first day, refreshed every three years, and a one-time home office stipend of $500. Every employee also has a learning budget of $1,500 per year for courses, books and conferences.

Security basics

- Multi-factor authentication is mandatory on every company account.
- Use the company password manager; never reuse passwords.
- Lock your screen whenever you step away, including in the office.
- Report a suspected incident within one hour in the #security channel or at security@northwind.example. The Security Incident Response Runbook explains severities and who is paged.

Performance and growth

Performance reviews happen twice a year, in April and October. Each review covers your goals, how you worked with others and your growth plan. Promotions are decided in the October cycle.

Code of conduct

Treat colleagues, customers and partners with respect. Harassment and discrimination are never acceptable. Report concerns to your manager, People Operations or the anonymous ethics line.